

dot com” website. More than 150 similar complaints by previous employees should be a sign that things aren’t on the up-and-up. I also check out Vault.com and RipOffReport.com to see if I’m going to be working for a product or service that generally makes people mad.

6. They don’t treat you well at the interview or application appointment

I know that when times are tough, it seems like just about any job should suffice. Take it from me, however: A hiring manager who can’t give you common courtesies probably won’t be the best person to work for. Rude receptionists, inconsiderately late HR reps, and a general feeling of frustration in a potential workplace are usually signs of an office-wide dilemma. Unless you’re craving workplace drama, it might be best to go with your gut and skip a questionable opportunity.

As much time as most people spend searching, applying, and interviewing during the job hunt, you owe it to yourself to be sure your next job is a keeper. If you can’t land that killer opportunity without sacrificing your most basic standards, it may be best to keep looking. — **Linsey Knerl**

4 Ways Good Writing Skills Save and Earn You Money



Here is a list of ways good writing skills could save and earn money for you.

1. You will be able to negotiate more effectively

My grandfather told me that he saved about \$4,500 on his condo purchase because he wrote a nice letter about why he deserved a discount. He showed me the letter, and it was very concise and listed both personal and business reasons why he should get a price break. If he did not know how to write so clearly, he might not have gotten the discount.

My mom also did the same thing when she and my dad purchased their first home. She wrote a clear letter detailing the issues surrounding the house and got a discount of \$7,500 beyond the accepted offer.